

Pacific Reef Research Institute

Community Outreach Program

Annual Community Engagement Summary Report

Reporting Year: 2025

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Executive Summary

The PRRI Community Outreach Program conducted six public engagement events in 2025, reaching a total of 1,284 community members. Events ranged from large-format public demonstrations to small educator workshops. Program activities were funded through Grant CCF-2023-HI-0047 and supported by in-kind contributions from Waikiki Aquarium, Malama Learning Center, and Surfrider Foundation Hawaii.

Events Summary

Event 1: Ocean Discovery Day - Spring

Date: April 19, 2025

Location: Waikiki Aquarium, Honolulu

Attendance: 208

Format: Open-house public demonstration with GoPro reef footage, coral ID activity, and Q and A

Outcome: Post-event survey completed by 142 attendees; 91% rated session as informative or highly informative. 16 new newsletter sign-ups.

Event 2: Hanauma Bay Community Reef Walk

Date: June 7, 2025

Location: Hanauma Bay Nature Preserve

Attendance: 94

Format: Guided snorkel orientation and guided reef walk with interpretive signage

Outcome: Informal feedback uniformly positive; 12 participants asked to join email newsletter.

Event 3: Marine Science Career Panel - Kaimuki High School

Date: August 22, 2025

Location: Kaimuki High School, Honolulu

Attendance: 34

Format: Panel of three marine scientists; Angela presented career path and current research; Q and A with students

Outcome: Post-panel survey (teacher-administered); 29 of 34 students reported increased interest in a science career.

Event 4: Ocean Discovery Day - Fall

Date: November 8, 2025

Location: Waikiki Aquarium, Honolulu

Attendance: 182

Format: Same format as spring event; additional Phase III Station C awareness content added

Outcome: Post-event surveys completed (134 returned). 94% rated session as informative or highly informative. Station C bleaching awareness segment well received. 21 new newsletter sign-ups.

Event 5: Reef Curriculum Workshop for Educators

Date: December 2, 2025
Location: Kaimana Elementary School, Honolulu
Attendance: 14

Format: Half-day workshop; curriculum materials provided via Google Classroom; hands-on activities with coral specimens

Outcome: 14 of 14 educators rated materials as excellent; follow-up email interest from 3 schools for future visits. 3 newsletter sign-ups.

Event 6: Waikiki Reef Sunrise Walk

Date: December 20, 2025
Location: Waikiki Beach
Attendance: 752

Format: Large-format public reef and beach clean walk in partnership with Surfrider Foundation Hawaii and Hawaii Wildlife Fund; Angela gave 10-minute remarks on reef health

Outcome: Angela's remarks well received; 40 new newsletter sign-ups at PRRI table.

Total 2025 Impact

Total events:	6
Total attendees:	1,284
Newsletter sign-ups generated:	92
Partner organizations engaged:	7
Educator contacts reached:	14

Program Assessment

The 2025 outreach program exceeded its annual contact target of 1,000 community members, driven primarily by Event 6 co-sponsorship. Programs focused exclusively on PRRI-led events averaged 106 attendees per event, consistent with prior years.

Educational events (events 3 and 5) demonstrated the strongest evidence-based impact per contact, with high reported behavior change intent from surveys.

Recommendation: Maintain large-format aquarium events as anchor events; increase educator-focused workshops from one to two per year given high outcome scores. Community outreach planning continuing into 2026.

Report submitted to Dr. Keanu Palani and CCF program officer January 12, 2026.